TASI daily strategies, period by period

All Tadawul All Share names. Daily frame. Every variant.

252 listed names, 155 scored, 97 skipped, 0 failed

Research prototype. Not investment advice. October 2026.

1. Question and answer

The 102-asset study found the daily edge concentrated in TASI stocks, on 12 names and one long evaluation window. This run asks whether that class result holds for the rest of the Tadawul All Share list, and whether it holds in separate periods rather than in a single average.

What was run

- Universe: every constituent of the Tadawul All Share index, 252 names, Yahoo symbols XXXX.SR.
- Model: the daily feature frame and the same walk-forward ensemble. The decision is the next session, not the next week.
- Weekly bars are still built for each name on a Thursday close. They are not inputs to this model. The weekly feature pipeline remains in the codebase for a later test.
- Periods: 2013-2015, 2016-2018, 2019-2021, and 2022-2026 when the name has them. Names that cannot fill two of those blocks use two-year blocks instead. A block needs 180 sessions, and 120 earlier prediction sessions to fit a threshold.
- Binary (t=opt) and Scaled are reported two ways. Refit uses only the three years before that period. Frozen uses one threshold fit before the first period and keeps it.
- Cost is 2 bps of the position change. The same cost used in the 102-asset study. TASI spreads are often wider than that.

Short answer

The daily TASI result is real on average and it is not confined to the original 12 names. It is not uniform. Some periods and some variants carry it, and a fixed zero threshold does not beat buy-and-hold for every name in every window.

Binary (t=0) beats that name's own buy-and-hold in 290 of 438 name-periods (66%). It does so in a majority of periods for 103 of 155 names (66%), and in every one of its periods for 50 names. The median gap is +0.187 Sharpe (0.404 versus buy-and-hold 0.244).

On the full window after the first period, with one frozen rule, Binary (t=0) beats buy-and-hold for 114 of 155 names. Median Sharpe 0.361 versus 0.165. Median CAGR 6.0% versus -0.1%. Median max drawdown -47.6% versus -66.7%.

The original 12 names, scored again inside this same run, beat buy-and-hold in 28 of 35 of their periods (median gap +0.279). The other 143 scored names beat it in 262 of 403 periods (median gap +0.181). The class result is not an artifact of those 12 tickers.

2. How look-ahead was kept out

- The target on day t is the return to the next close. Features on day t use the close of day t.
- Each walk-forward fold selects features and stops training on the tail of the past only.
- A period's refit threshold is fit on predictions dated before the period starts. The period's own days are not in that fit.
- The frozen threshold is fit once, on the block before the first scored period, and then left alone. Later periods do not update it.
- Adaptive may use the previous 126 predictions and their realized returns. It may not use the current day or any later day.
- Macro series are forward-filled onto the Saudi session. Nothing is back-filled. Leading HMM states are not back-filled.
- Thursday weekly bars are stored beside the run. They are not columns in the model that produced these numbers.

No scored name had 400 feature rows before 2010, so none used that anchor. All 155 scored names start the walk-forward once those 400 rows exist. Yahoo's daily history, after the indicator and HMM warmup, is what sets that date. The first block the three-year grid can fill is 2016-2018, not 2013-2015. 142 names used the three-year grid. 13 used two-year blocks. 97 names were skipped because the history cannot support two separate periods.

3. All variants, across periods

Each row pools every name and every period. Beat is the share of those pairs where the strategy Sharpe is above buy-and-hold. Majority is the share of names for which that happens in more than half of their periods. In market is the median share of sessions with a position.

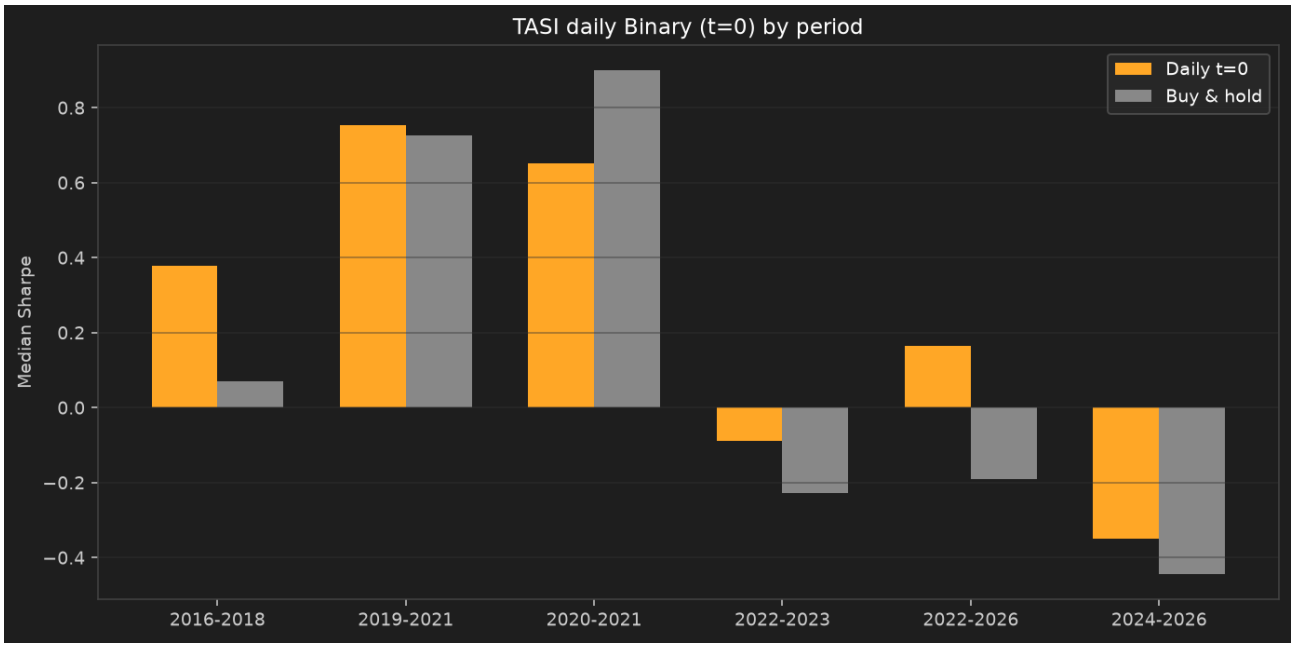
Variant	Beat	Share	Majority	Med gap	Med Sh	Med BnH	In mkt
t=0	290/438	66%	103/155	+0.187	0.40	0.24	58%
t=opt refit	233/438	53%	76/155	+0.019	0.27	0.24	19%
t=opt frozen	214/438	49%	65/155	+0.000	0.20	0.24	4%
Scaled refit	275/438	63%	100/155	+0.191	0.42	0.24	58%
Scaled frozen	264/438	60%	94/155	+0.170	0.39	0.24	58%
Adaptive	285/438	65%	98/155	+0.144	0.38	0.24	53%

Binary (t=opt) refit is in the market a median 19% of the time and below 20% in 224 of 438 name-periods. The frozen threshold is in the market a median 4% of the time and below 20% in 360 name-periods. A threshold that looked good before the period still goes to cash often. Binary (t=0) does not have that free parameter.

4. Does any one period carry the result?

Median Sharpe of Binary (t=0) against buy-and-hold in each calendar block. A class claim needs more than one block.

Period	N	t=0 beat	t=0 Sh	BnH	t=0 gap	t=opt gap
2016-2018	126	93/126	0.38	0.07	+0.32	+0.05
2019-2021	142	77/142	0.75	0.73	+0.06	-0.06
2020-2021	2	0/2	0.65	0.90	-0.25	-0.95
2022-2023	13	6/13	-0.09	-0.23	-0.05	+0.00
2022-2026	142	109/142	0.17	-0.19	+0.23	+0.09
2024-2026	13	5/13	-0.35	-0.44	-0.03	-0.23



Periods where t=0 beats buy-and-hold on at least 55% of names: 2016-2018, 2022-2026. Periods under half: 2020-2021, 2022-2023, 2024-2026. The rows with a handful of names are the two-year grid. Read 2016-2018, 2019-2021, and 2022-2026. Those three each have more than 100 names.

The edge is large when buy-and-hold is weak. In 2016-2018 the median buy-and-hold Sharpe is 0.07 and the t=0 gap is +0.32 (93 of 126 names). In 2022-2026 buy-and-hold is -0.19 and t=0 is 0.17, gap +0.23 (109 of 142). In that window the

strategy is in the market a median 62% of sessions, so part of the gain is time in cash. In 2019-2021 both are strong (t=0 0.75, buy-and-hold 0.73) and the gap shrinks to +0.06, with t=0 ahead on 77 of 142 names. The class result is still there in that bull window. It is much thinner.

5. The original 12 against the rest of the market

These 12 names are the TASI stocks in the earlier 102-asset study. They are scored here with the same daily code and the same period rules as every other name.

Group	Names	Beat	Share	Majority	Every period	Med gap
Original 12	12	28/35	80%	11/12	6/12	+0.279
All other scored names	143	262/403	65%	92/143	44/143	+0.181
Every scored name	155	290/438	66%	103/155	50/155	+0.187

Majority means the name beat buy-and-hold in more than half of its periods. Every period means it beat buy-and-hold in all of them. A name with two periods must win both.

6. What to take from this

The daily TASI result is real on average and it is not confined to the original 12 names. It is not uniform. Some periods and some variants carry it, and a fixed zero threshold does not beat buy-and-hold for every name in every window.

- Judge the class on Binary (t=0) first. It beats buy-and-hold in 66% of name-periods, median gap +0.187. The full-window median CAGR is 6.0% against -0.1% for buy-and-hold, and the median max drawdown is -47.6% against -66.7%.
- Median gap for the refit threshold is +0.019. Median gap for one frozen threshold is +0.000. Median gap for the zero threshold is +0.187. Cash-heavy thresholds remain common, so a fitted cutoff still needs a guardrail that rejects a rule which would sit out most of the period.
- The weekly feature code is unchanged and still causal: a Thursday bar is available the next session, not on the Thursday itself. This study did not put those columns into the model. The earlier 102-asset run is the evidence on mixing, and it did not help the typical asset.

This is a research prototype. The 2 bp cost is the study convention, not a TASI spread. Names without two separate evaluation windows are excluded rather than scored on a short history. The result is a class tendency across periods, not a portfolio and not a forecast for the next listing.